

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 288

By Marsh

A RESOLUTION to congratulate Bruce MacDonald and his horse Cavender, the eighty-sixth Tennessee Walking Horse National Celebration World Grand Champion.

WHEREAS, the Tennessee Walking Horse National Celebration in Shelbyville is the premier event for the Tennessee Walking Horse industry, showcasing these magnificent horses and crowning the breed's World Grand Champion; and

WHEREAS, Bruce MacDonald and his horse Cavender, by a unanimous selection of the judge panel, captured the 2024 World Grand Championship at the eighty-sixth annual Tennessee Walking Horse National Celebration; and

WHEREAS, no stranger to success, Bruce MacDonald had a prosperous business career with franchises for Cummins diesel engines and Carrier Transicold; after Mr. MacDonald and his wife raised their two sons, Mrs. MacDonald thought it time to return to her love of horses, and together, the couple captured success in the show ring; and

WHEREAS, Cavender was trained and ridden to victory by Tim Smith, who first spotted the smooth moving, high-headed colt at the Abernathy Colt Preview in Mississippi in 2021; and

WHEREAS, Bruce MacDonald moved quickly and purchased the horse; his wife, Robin MacDonald, named the colt Cavender, an Irish name, meaning someone who is bold or brave, and Brenda Corey raised him under the direction of Cottonwood Farm; and

WHEREAS, as time went on, Cavender was a winner each time he entered the show ring, earning blue ribbons at the ThorSport Spring Fling in Murfreesboro and the Spring Fun Show in Shelbyville; and

WHEREAS, the successes of the MacDonalds, their champion colt, Cavender, and his trainer and rider, Tim Smith, are a great source of pride for their families, their community, and this State; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that we hereby honor and congratulate Bruce MacDonald and his horse Cavender, the eighty-sixth annual Tennessee Walking Horse National Celebration World Grand Champion, and rider/trainer Tim Smith, commend them for their meritorious service to the Walking Horse industry and the State of Tennessee, and extend to them our best wishes for every future success.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.